

tasks such as social media, WhatsApp, YouTube, and web browsing, this phone handles it decently well. There were very few instances of lag. However, for pro users, there are much faster options in the market.

As for the software, the phone ships with ColorOS 14 which is layered on top of Android 14. OPPO has promised three whole years of OS updates and four years of security updates, which is a step in the right direction. Sadly, the bloatware is still very much an issue in ColorOS 14 on the Reno11. There are a ton of pre-installed apps, many of which cannot be uninstalled.

CAMERAS

The OPPO Reno11 5G's triple camera array looks impressive on paper. You've got an improved 50-megapixel primary camera with Optical Image Stabilisation (OIS), there's a 32-megapixel telephoto shooter with 2x optical zoom and an 8-megapixel ultrawide camera. The selfie camera is a pretty capable 32-megapixel sensor.

The photos from the primary camera in ideal lighting look pretty decent. Colours are contrasty and vivid – ideal for direct uploads to social media and the detail retention is solid. The dynamic range, while not the worst in the segment, could be better. The details in the shadows get crushed quite a bit even in good lighting. And this is only amplified in low light conditions, with some noise creeping in as well.

The 8-megapixel ultrawide camera is nothing special – the centre of the picture has good amounts of detail, but the corners lose out on it and the dynamic range is worse here. As for the 32-megapixel telephoto lens, the colours and detail retention are surprisingly good. OPPO has also done a good job of maintaining similar colour science across its lenses.

Portrait pictures, on the other hand, are a different story. In ideal lighting, both the primary and telephoto cameras click good portrait shots. However, the details on a person's face are more smoothened over in the primary sample,



which gives it an unnatural look. In low light, the telephoto lens clicks very soft portrait images that aren't really usable, in my opinion.

The 32-megapixel selfie camera clicks some stunning photos in daylight, but in low light conditions, the pretty goes missing once again. Overall, while the OPPO Reno11's cameras are above average, they are nothing spectacular.

BATTERY LIFE

Battery capacity and charging speeds remain unchanged on the OPPO Reno11 5G. Just like the Reno10, the OPPO Reno11 houses a 5,000 mAh cell with support for 67 W fast charging. The phone will last most users about a day, but if you're a heavy user, you may even need to charge up the device before your bedtime.

In our 4K video loop test, the OPPO Reno11 5G lasted for about 13 hours before dying out from a full battery. A mere 15 minutes of playing Call of Duty: Mobile drained the battery by about 6 per cent. These are decent numbers, but nothing path-breaking. The 67 W charger tops the phone from empty to full in just 49 minutes, which is quite speedy.

VERDICT

The OPPO Reno11 5G is a striking smartphone. It will certainly turn heads with its polarising design – whether you like it or not is your personal preference

but it's definitely eye-catching. However, the Reno11 just doesn't feel like a next-generation product – it is a moderately tuned OPPO Reno10, which by itself wasn't the most impressive smartphone in its price range. OPPO really needs to start paying more attention to the processor and battery of its phones to stand out in the competitive Indian smartphone market since these are key areas of interest. The cameras, which are supposed to be one of the Reno11's standout features, also are quite inconsistent.

Other options in this price range are the POCO X6 Pro, for exceptional speed, and the Realme 12 Pro, for a better camera experience at a cheaper price. You could also spend about ₹2K more and go for the fantastic Redmi Note 13 Pro+ which has a better display, faster charging, and smoother game-play experience.

–Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

Colours: Wave Green, Rock Grey | Weight: 182 g | Processor: MediaTek Dimensity 7050 | RAM: 8 GB LPDDR4X | Storage: 128 / 256 GB UFS 2.2 | Display: 6.7" FHD+ AMOLED, 120 Hz, HDR10+ | OS: Android 14, ColorOS 14 | Cameras (rear): 50 MP main + 32 MP telephoto + 8 MP ultrawide | Selfie camera: 32 MP | Battery capacity: 5,000 mAh | Charging: 67 W

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